of the Allies.

Josef said goodbye to the patients, reassuring them that the Soviet army would have a doctor to care for them. André arrived at six-thirty, a small bag over his shoulder. Rose was the last one, carrying a backpack.

“Come on, Rose, we’re going home,” Léa said.

A bird sang. Rose put her arms around Léa. “I love you,” she whispered.

“I love you, too, little sis,” Léa said, noticing that Rose stood unusually still and quiet. An uneasy feeling crept over Léa. Then she realized Rose had forgotten her drawings.

“You must bring your sketchbooks.” She’d spent hours drawing portraits of the Russian women in the sick bay. Léa thought they were her best work.

Rose blinked. “Yes. I’ll ask the driver to stop by the barracks on the way.”

A car engine sent them outside. It was one of Reinhardt’s men driving a two-door cabriolet Opel. Though he was dressed in civilian clothes, a Gestapo officer’s hardness in his face and eyes remained. The driver tapped his watch, hurrying them along.

Josef sat in the front. André, Rose and Léa settled in the back, with Katya sleeping on Léa’s lap. The car started. Rose leaned forward, asking the driver to stop at the barracks. He nodded. Léa thought it odd that he didn’t complain since he seemed to be in a hurry. Maybe it was because they would be taking the road north that led out of town. When they arrived at the barracks, Rose slipped a note in André’s hand, and whispered, “Don’t read it until I return.” Then she jumped out. The driver kept the engine running.

The ground beneath them trembled as a deep *grrrr-grrrr-thud* thundered through the air. Up ahead, a Panzer tank, heading south, was about to pass them. Every door and window in the Opel rattled. The car shook, like a boat on water, buckling against the force of the tank. Léa’s skin vibrated, as if it was sliding away from the bones on her face. Katya opened her eyes and cried.

“Hush, little one,” Léa cooed. “Your aunt will be—”

The tank commander, towering, stood up in the open hatch. He glanced down, and the driver saluted. A grinding, metallic clatter continued as more Panzers followed, heading south. Léa could taste the acrid diesel in her